

SNOWBE ONLINE Policy# SDLC-01

System Development Life Cycle

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System Development Life Cycle – Version 1.0

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Purpose

This policy establishes SnowBe Online's requirements for managing security throughout the full system development life cycle for new systems, major enhancements, infrastructure changes, platform changes, and technology implementations. The policy defines how security must be incorporated into planning, requirements, design, acquisition, development, testing, deployment, operation, maintenance, and retirement so that SnowBe reduces business risk while supporting reliable business growth. This policy exists to ensure that systems supporting e-commerce, customer data, payment processing, internal operations, cloud services, and on-premise resources are designed and managed using a consistent life cycle approach aligned with systems security engineering principles.

Scope

This policy applies to all SnowBe employees, contractors, consultants, developers, engineers, project managers, system owners, administrators, and third-party providers involved in planning, acquiring, designing, building, integrating, testing, deploying, operating, maintaining, or retiring SnowBe systems. It applies to AWS-hosted environments, on-premise servers, network devices, retail support systems, access management systems, laptops, desktops, security tools, and any supporting technology that stores, processes, transmits, or protects company, customer, employee, vendor, or payment-related information. It also applies to major system changes, replacement efforts, and integrations with external services or vendors.

Definitions

Acquisition

The process of obtaining systems, components, software, services, or technology capabilities from internal or external sources.

Baseline Security Requirements

The minimum required security controls, design expectations, and protection measures that must be addressed for a system before approval and deployment.

Life Cycle Phase

A defined stage in the existence of a system, such as planning, design, development, testing, deployment, operation, maintenance, or retirement.

Risk Assessment

The process of identifying threats, vulnerabilities, likelihood, impact, and overall risk to organizational systems or data.

Security Requirements

Documented protection needs that must be addressed by a system to support confidentiality, integrity, availability, privacy, compliance, and resilience objectives.

System

Any organized combination of hardware, software, firmware, data, people, processes, services, facilities, or external dependencies used to deliver a business or technical capability.

System Development Life Cycle (SDLC)

A structured approach used to guide a system from initial concept through planning, design, implementation, operation, maintenance, and retirement while addressing business, technical, and security requirements throughout the process.

System Owner

The individual responsible for the overall business function, risk acceptance, and operational oversight of a system.

Threat Modeling

A structured activity used to identify potential threats, attack paths, design weaknesses, trust boundaries, and required mitigations before and during system implementation.

Roles & Responsibilities

Application Owner

Ensures that business application requirements are defined, approved, and aligned with operational needs before implementation. The Application Owner also confirms that required functionality and security expectations are maintained through testing and deployment.

Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)

Provides executive oversight of SnowBe Online's information security program and ensures that security policies, including the system development life cycle, are properly implemented and enforced. The CISO defines security requirements, reviews high-risk systems and changes, approves exceptions when necessary, and ensures that security practices align with business objectives, regulatory requirements, and risk management expectations.

Developer

Builds, configures, integrates, or modifies system components in accordance with approved design, security requirements, and implementation standards. Developers and Engineers must document changes, follow secure practices, and correct identified weaknesses before release.

Project Manager

Coordinates planning, scheduling, communication, deliverables, and stakeholder alignment for system initiatives. The Project Manager ensures that required reviews, approvals, testing milestones, and security checkpoints occur during the life cycle.

System Owner

Provides business direction, approves requirements, ensures appropriate funding and support, and accepts residual risk when necessary. The System Owner is accountable for confirming that the system remains appropriate for SnowBe's operational and compliance needs.

Technical Consultant

Advises SnowBe on secure architecture, threat modeling, risk reduction, vendor considerations, trust boundaries, and control integration throughout the system life cycle. This role helps ensure that systems are engineered to be defensible and support long-term business objectives.

Vendor

Must meet SnowBe security, contractual, and compliance expectations when delivering hosted services, integrated platforms, support services, or technology components that affect SnowBe systems or data.

Policy

SnowBe Online shall manage all systems using a structured system development life cycle consisting of analysis, planning, design, development, testing, deployment, maintenance, evaluation, and disposal. Security must be integrated into each phase and may not be deferred or treated as a separate activity. All systems must have defined ownership, documented requirements, and formal approval before progressing between phases.

During analysis and planning, stakeholders must define system purpose, business requirements, data sensitivity, users, and dependencies. A risk assessment must be conducted to identify potential threats, vulnerabilities, and impacts. Security requirements must be documented and incorporated into planning decisions to ensure alignment with business and compliance needs.

During design, systems must be architected to meet security expectations, including access control, logging, encryption where required, and support for monitoring and recovery. Design decisions must account for trust boundaries, system interfaces, and integration points. Systems that cannot meet required security controls must not proceed without approved exceptions.

During development and testing, systems must be built according to approved specifications and validated prior to deployment. Testing must confirm that functionality, security controls, and system resilience meet requirements. Identified vulnerabilities must be remediated or formally accepted before systems are approved for production use.

During deployment and maintenance, systems must be securely implemented, documented, and continuously managed. This includes enforcing access controls, applying patches, monitoring system activity, maintaining logs, and validating backups. Significant changes that affect system architecture, exposure, or data handling must re-enter the appropriate life cycle phases for review.

During evaluation and disposal, systems must be periodically reviewed to ensure continued alignment with security and business requirements. When systems are retired, data must be securely removed or transferred, access must be revoked, and assets must be updated to prevent residual risk. Retired systems must not remain accessible or connected in a way that introduces security exposure.

Exceptions/Exemptions

Requests for exceptions must be submitted in writing to SnowBe Online's IT Security Manager for review and approval. Each request must include the business justification, defined scope, duration, and any compensating controls that will be applied. All approved exceptions will be formally documented, reviewed periodically for continued appropriateness, and remain valid for no longer than one year unless re-evaluated and re-approved.

Enforcement

Failure to follow this policy may result in disciplinary action, beginning with a verbal warning and escalating to written notice, suspension of system access, or termination of employment. Contractors and vendors who violate SnowBe Online's security or compliance requirements may have their access revoked or contracts terminated. Intentional or severe violations, especially those involving customer data or payment systems, may lead to termination and potential legal or regulatory action under applicable laws.

Version History Table

Version #	Implementation Date	Document Owner	Approved By	Description
1.0	03/29/2026	Jarred Ward	IT Security Manager	Original Draft

Citations

Salisbury University - https://www.salisbury.edu/administration/general-counsel/policies/section_X/X-27.00-SU-SDLCPolicy.pdf (Used for Purpose, Scope, Policy).

University of Kansas - <https://services.ku.edu/TDClient/818/Portal/KB/ArticleDet?ID=21409> (Used for Definitions, Exceptions/Exemptions).

U.S. Office of Personnel Management. - <https://www.opm.gov/about-us/open-government/digital-government-strategy/fitara/opm-system-development-life-cycle-policy-and-standards.pdf> (Used for Roles & Responsibilities, Enforcement).